

ARBA MINCH UNIVERSITY  
STREAM SELECTION QUALIFICATION EXAMINATION  
English for Law, Exam Code 01

**PASSAGE 1**

**Instruction 1:** Read the following passage and answer the questions that follow.

The first murder ever committed in the United States occurred in September 1630, shortly after the Pilgrims arrived in Massachusetts. John Billington was the father of two sons, one of the first to settle in the new Plymouth Colony near what is today Boston, and one of the people who signed the Mayflower Compact—and he was also the colony's first murderer.

Billington, in fact, was the first person to commit any crime in the colony, as far as we know today. He was also the first to be executed by the state in the New World. Billington's crime was to shoot a man named John Newcomen, for reasons which are lost to history.

But Billington's problems had not begun on the soil of North America. He and his sons had nearly caused a mutiny aboard the Mayflower during the arduous trip across the ocean. One of his sons, in fact, fired his gun aboard the Mayflower—near an open keg of gunpowder! The flash from the gun could easily have ignited the powder, which would probably have sunk the ship.

Once in Plymouth Colony, Billington's behavior did not improve. He refused to serve any form of military duty under the leadership of Miles Standish, a duty that was seen by the colonists as part of every man's responsibilities in the New World. He was later implicated in a plot to overthrow the entire leadership of Plymouth Colony, but a lack of evidence prompted the town's leaders to let him go free. In the end, Billington's rebellious and angry nature caught up with him. He was found guilty of the murder of John Newcomen, and died in disgrace on the gallows.

1. Based on the information in the passage, which of the following best describes John Billington?

- |                                            |                                                         |
|--------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| <input type="radio"/> A quiet and shy      | <input checked="" type="radio"/> B angry and rebellious |
| <input type="radio"/> C clever and amusing | <input type="radio"/> D bold and patriotic              |

2. Which of the following is NOT true of John Billington, according to the passage?

- |                                                     |                                                                         |
|-----------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <input checked="" type="radio"/> A He had two sons. | <input type="radio"/> B He served in the military under Miles Standish. |
| <input type="radio"/> C He tried to lead a mutiny.  | <input type="radio"/> D He attempted to overthrow the government.       |

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3. The nearest meaning of the underlined word arduous, as used in the passage, is
- ☐ A. difficult                      ☐ B. simple  
☐ C. long                              ☐ D. stormy
4. Why didn't the leaders of Plymouth Colony punish Billington for rebelling against their authority?
- ☐ A. He was not guilty.                      ☐ B. They didn't have enough evidence.  
☐ C. He had two sons who needed him.                      ☐ D. Billington was Miles Standish's nephew.
5. A good title for this passage would be:
- ☐ A. History of Plymouth Colony                      ☐ B. The Injustices of Miles Standish  
☐ C. America's First Murderer                      ☐ D. Early American Legal Battles

## II. VOCABULARY

**Instruction II: Read the following sentences and try to choose the best definition for the underlined word by searching for context clues in the sentence.**

6. The attorney wanted to expedite the process because her client was becoming impatient.
- ☐ A. reverse                      ☐ B. evaluate                      ☐ C. accelerate                      ☐ D. justify
7. She showed a blatant disregard for the rules.
- ☐ A. obvious                      ☐ B. hidden                      ☐ C. last-minute                      ☐ D. rebellious
8. Since the townspeople were so dissatisfied, various methods to alleviate the situation were debated.
- ☐ A. clarify                      ☐ B. tolerate                      ☐ C. ease                      ☐ D. intensify
9. The doctors were pleased that their theory had been fortified by the new research.
- ☐ A. disputed                      ☐ B. reinforced                      ☐ C. altered                      ☐ D. developed
10. The editor of the newspaper needed to be sure the article presented the right information, so his review was meticulous.
- ☐ A. painstaking                      ☐ B. objective                      ☐ C. delicate                      ☐ D. superficial

### III. PASSAGE 2

**Instruction III: Read the following passage and answer the questions that follow.**

(1) An upsurge of new research suggests that animals have a much higher level of brainpower than previously thought. If animals do have intelligence, how do scientists measure it? Before defining animals' intelligence, scientists defined what is not intelligence. Instinct is not intelligence. It is a skill programmed into an animal's brain by its genetic heritage. Rote conditioning is also not intelligence. Tricks can be learned by repetition, but no real thinking is involved. Cuing, in which animals learn to do or not to do certain things by following outside signals, does not demonstrate intelligence. Scientists believe that insight, the ability to use tools, and communication using human language are all effective measures of the mental ability of animals.

(2) When judging animal intelligence, scientists look for insight, which they define as a flash of sudden understanding. When a young gorilla could not reach fruit from a tree, she noticed crates scattered about the lawn near the tree. She piled the crates into a pyramid, then climbed on them to reach her reward. The gorilla's insight allowed her to solve a new problem without trial and error.

(3) The ability to use tools is also an important sign of intelligence. Crows use sticks to pry peanuts out of cracks. The crow exhibits intelligence by showing it has learned what a stick can do. Likewise, otters use rocks to crack open crab shells in order to get at the meat. In a series of complex moves, chimpanzees have been known to use sticks and stalks in order to get at a favorite snack—termites. To make and use a termite tool, a chimp first selects just the right stalk or twig. He trims and shapes the stick, then finds the entrance to a termite mound. While inserting the stick carefully into the entrance, the chimpanzee turns it skillfully to fit the inner tunnels. The chimp attracts the insects by shaking the twig. Then it pulls the tool out without scraping off any termites. Finally, he uses his lips to skim the termites into his mouth.

(4) Many animals have learned to communicate using human language. Some primates have learned hundreds of words in sign language. One chimp can recognize and correctly use more than 250 abstract symbols on a keyboard. These symbols represent human words. An amazing

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parrot can distinguish five objects of two different types. He can understand the difference between the number, color, and kind of object. The ability to classify is a basic thinking skill. He seems to use language to express his needs and emotions. When ill and taken to the animal hospital for his first overnight stay, this parrot turned to go. "Come here!" he cried to a scientist who works with him. "I love you. I'm sorry. Wanna go back?"

(5) The research on animal intelligence raises important questions. If animals are smarter than once thought, would that change the way humans interact with them? Would humans stop hunting them for sport or survival? Would animals still be used for food, clothing, or medical experimentation? Finding the answer to these tough questions makes a difficult puzzle even for a large-brained, problem-solving species like our own.

11. Crows use sticks to pry peanuts out of cracks. Which of the following is the kind of intelligence or conditioning the situation describes?

- ☐ A rote learning    ☐ B tools    ☐ C communication    ☐ D instinct

12. The underlined word upsurge, as it is used in the first paragraph of the passage, most nearly means

- ☐ A an immeasurable amount    ☐ B a decreasing amount  
☐ C a well-known amount    ☐ D an increasingly large amount

13. The concluding paragraph of this passage infers which of the following?

- ☐ A Research showing higher animal intelligence may fuel debate on ethics and cruelty.  
☐ B Animals are being given opportunities to display their intelligence.  
☐ C There is no definitive line between those animals with intelligence and those without.  
☐ D Animals are capable of untrained thought well beyond mere instinct.

14. Which of the following is not a sign of animal intelligence?

- ☐ A shows insight    ☐ B cues    ☐ C uses tools    ☐ D makes a plan

15. In paragraph 3, what conclusion can be reached about the chimpanzee's ability to use a tool?

- ☐ A It illustrates high intelligence because he is able to get his food and eat it.  
☐ B It illustrates instinct because he faced a difficult task and accomplished it.  
☐ C It illustrates high intelligence because he stored knowledge away and called it up at the right time.  
☐ D It illustrates high intelligence because termites are protein-packed.